



## THE PARASHA BY THE NUMBERS

|              |              |                       |                      |
|--------------|--------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| 52<br>VERSES | 616<br>WORDS | 340<br>DISTINCT ROOTS | 11<br>HAPAX LEGOMENA |
|--------------|--------------|-----------------------|----------------------|

## MOST FREQUENT ROOTS

|      |                      |    |
|------|----------------------|----|
| כי   | relative conjunction | 19 |
| לא   | not                  | 16 |
| על   | above                | 12 |
| בן   | son                  | 12 |
| אשר  | who                  | 12 |
| עם   | people               | 10 |
| יהוה | Existent             | 9  |
| ארץ  | earth                | 8  |
| צור  | cliff                | 8  |
| הוא  | he                   | 8  |

## WHAT THE SONG CALLS GOD

|       |                    |   |
|-------|--------------------|---|
| יהוה  | the Tetragrammaton | 9 |
| צור   | Rock               | 8 |
| אל    | God                | 4 |
| אלהים | God (plural form)  | 4 |
| אלוה  | God (poetic)       | 2 |
| עליון | Most High          | 1 |

Six different designations in one poem, and צור — "rock" — is second only to the Name itself: הצור תמים פעלו: צור, צור ישעתו, הצור תמים פעלו: ילדך תשי. That concentration is what the first note overleaf is about. The word Ha'azinu turns into a divine name is the word modern Israel turned into a national one.

Averaging 11.8 words a verse, and lopsided: the song itself (32:1–43) runs to 463 words, the prose frame around it only 153. The longest verse is 32:49 at 24 words; the shortest, 32:16, has 4.

## ELEVEN WORDS THAT OCCUR NOWHERE ELSE IN THE BIBLE

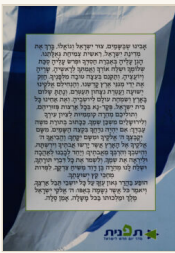
|       |              |                             |       |             |                       |
|-------|--------------|-----------------------------|-------|-------------|-----------------------|
| 32:2  | בְּשֻׁעֵי    | like rain-showers on grass  | 32:5  | פְּתֻלָּתָל | twisted, crooked      |
| 32:10 | יִלֵּל       | howling (waste)             | 32:14 | חֲמָר       | foaming wine          |
| 32:15 | פָּשִׁיתָ    | you grew gross with fat     | 32:18 | תִּשִּׁי    | you neglected, forgot |
| 32:24 | מְזִי        | drained, wasted (by hunger) | 32:24 | מְרִירִי    | bitter destruction    |
| 32:26 | אֶפְאַיֵּהֶם | I will blow them away       | 32:34 | כִּמְס      | sealed up in store    |
| 32:35 | וְשִׁלֵּם    | and requital                |       |             |                       |

Hapax legomena, counted against the whole Tanakh: eleven of this parasha's 340 roots are used exactly once in all of Scripture, and 255 more appear only once here. The archaism runs through the grammar too: seven words carry the old poetic *־מו* plural ending (לָמוּ, עָלִימוּ, אֱלֹהֵימוּ, זִכְרֵימוּ) where ordinary Hebrew would use *־הֶם*. Much of the poem's difficulty is that there is nothing else to compare its words to.

32:4 הצור / צור יִשְׂרָאֵל

צור ישראל *divine epithet “the Rock” becomes the civil-religious national formula*

Ha’azinu makes צור “rock” a recurring name for God: צור ילדך חשי. In modern Israel the epithet becomes a civil-religious formula: the 1948 Declaration of Independence closes בצור ישראל, and a phrase religious and secular signatories could each read their own way, and the Prayer for the State opens צור ישראל וגואלו. In everyday speech the physical “rock” is צור סלע; literary/elevated, and צור ישראל is heard mainly as a national-liturgical name.



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32:13 תְּנוּבַת שָׂדֵי / תְּנוּבָה

תְּנוּבָה poetic “produce/yield” becomes the name of the national dairy cooperative Tnuva

תְּנוּבָה is the yield or produce of the land, a rare poetic noun. Zionist agricultural Hebrew adopted it as the name of Tnuva, the cooperative that marketed the produce of Jewish farms (founded 1926), and Otto Wallish’s mid-century posters made תְּנוּבָה a household brand. The common noun still exists in elevated or technical register (“yield”), but for most Israeli speakers the word now first evokes the dairy company.



Otto Wallish for Tnuva  
FL212082264

32:14 חֶמְאָת בָּקָר / חֶמְאָה

חֶמְאָה curdled milk / cream specializes to “butter”

חֶמְאָה lists חמאה among the rich dairy of the land. Biblical חמאה is a cultured or curdled milk product that can be drunk: Yael, asked for water, gives Sisera milk, חמאה הקריבה חמאה (Judges 5:25), and Abraham serves חמאה וחלב (Genesis 18:8). Modern Hebrew narrows חמאה to “butter,” the solid churned fat, as on Tnuva’s 1968 poster מלוחה חמאה (“salted butter”); other cultured milks get new names (לֶבֶן, יוֹגוּרֵט, שֶׁמֶנֶת).



Otto Wallish for Tnuva, 1968  
FL212081970



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HOW THE LEVITES DIVIDED IT

| הָאֲזִינוּ         | זָכַר               | יִרְכָּבֶהוּ         | וַיֵּרָא             | לֹלֵי                | כִּי יֵדִין          |
|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 32:1–6<br>63 words | 32:7–12<br>62 words | 32:13–18<br>68 words | 32:19–26<br>86 words | 32:27–35<br>87 words | 32:36–43<br>97 words |

At the Shabbat additional offering the Levites sang Ha’azinu not all at once but one section a week, six weeks to a cycle, under the mnemonic **הַזִּי"ו ל"ה** — the opening letter of each section (Rosh Hashanah 31a). Rav adds that the song is divided the same way in the synagogue, which is why Ha’azinu still gets six aliyot rather than seven — and the sections grow steadily longer as the poem turns from teaching to judgement, 63 words to 97.

MY NOTES

Nothing recorded yet — the notes field is empty for every verse of Deuteronomy 32.